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OPR: WVOT Operations

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

Publications are available online at
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Questions and change recommendations related to this publication shall be directed to this publication's Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR). This policy shall be reviewed annually to ensure continued alignment with current legal, operational, and strategic requirements. Revisions will be undertaken as necessary.

SUMMARY OF VERSIONS AND CHANGES

Version	Date	Revision Description
1	1/30/2015	Changed WVOT responsibilities in 3.1 and deleted 3.5
2	07/01/2015	Added Change Log and Definitions, and reorganized
3	09/01/2016	Added sections 3.12-3.15
4	10/20/2017	Reviewed - No Changes
5	12/31/2023	Updated website information in section 4.0
6	03/27/2026	Reformatted and deleted section on Temporary Accounts

1. PURPOSE

1.1. This policy will establish a standard for the administration of computing accounts that facilitate access or changes to State of West Virginia (State) Executive Branch data. This policy will also establish standards for creating, issuing, removing, monitoring, and managing employee accounts.

2. SCOPE

2.1. This policy applies to all departments (including agencies, boards, authorities, and commissions) within the Executive Branch of WV State Government, excluding constitutional officers, the WV Board of Education, the WV Department of Education, and the county boards of education that have access to or use State-provided resources.

2.2. Where there are policies in place which provide less restrictions or security than this policy, those policies will be superseded by this policy. In instances where existing state and federal laws, regulations, and policies are more restrictive, the more restrictive provisions will prevail.

3. POLICY

3.1. The WVOT is responsible for adding, modifying, and deleting network users' account access for Executive Branch agencies. Name changes, account changes, and permission changes are all documented.

3.2. All accounts must be requested via the self-service portal utilizing the Employee Network Account service request and approved by the DAA (Designated Approval Authority. User accounts will not be activated until the authorization process and all required documentation have been successfully completed..

3.3. The WVOT will issue a unique account to each individual authorized to access a particular networked computing and information resource.

3.4. Upon an employee's termination, retirement, or reassignment, agencies are required to complete an Employee Deprovision Service Request via the WVOT Self Service Support portal, with approval from the agency's Designated Approval Authority (DAA). Should an employee's account require immediate disabling, the Service Desk must be contacted as soon as possible.

3.4.1. All accounts are moved to archived accounts upon deprovision. These accounts will be identified by "arc" in the front of the EID (Executive ID) and E-Mail (Electronic Mail).

3.5. When establishing accounts, standard security principles of "least privilege access" to perform a function must always be used, where administratively feasible.

3.6. Each agency must have a documented process for periodically reviewing existing accounts to ensure that access and account privileges are proportionate with job function, need-to-know, and employment status. WVOT reserves the right to perform audits on an ad hoc basis. (See WVOT-PO1008 – "Information Security Auditing Program" for more information.)

3.7. Each Executive Branch agency will appoint one (or more) employee(s) to serve as a designated approval authority. This individual(s) will authorize all access modifications for that agency. All additions and changes to the agency DAA must be made using the DAA Change form on the WVOT Self Service Portal.

3.8. Agencies must monitor and regularly update approval authorities.

3.9. Owners of systems, applications, or infrastructure utilizing **Service Accounts** (automated accounts with elevated permissions) must implement formal, auditable procedures for the management and oversight of these credentials. To ensure security and operational continuity, the following requirements must be met as outlined:

3.9.1. **Principle of Least Privilege:** Service Accounts must be configured with the minimum level of access and permissions required to perform their designated function. Excessive or 'administrator-level' permissions must be justified and reviewed annually.

3.9.2. **Credential Governance:** Service Account credentials (such as passwords, API keys, or tokens) must be stored in a secure digital vault or secret management system to prevent unauthorized knowledge of shared secrets.

3.9.3. **Emergency Procedures:** Documented 'break-glass' procedures must be maintained to allow for the immediate rotation or reset of credentials should the primary administrator become unavailable or the account be compromised.

3.9.4. **Accountability:** The procedures must define the designated roles within the chain-of-command authorized to access, reset, or override these credentials, ensuring all such actions are logged for audit purposes."

3.10. When the employee status of personnel who have access to super-passwords changes, the passwords must be changed. Changes in employee status include, but are not limited to: termination, resignation, retirement, and change of departments or agencies.

3.11. Contractor or Vendor accounts are designated by using V in the Executive ID (V123456). These accounts follow the same rules for creation, modification and deprovisioning as normal Executive Accounts (See 3.1 through 3.4).

3.12. If a Vendor or Contractor is hired on as a permanent state employee they are REQUIRED to request a change using the Simple Employee Change service request via the WVOT self-service portal.

3.13. Use of shared accounts is not permitted.

3.13.1. Exceptions will require documentation to justify the need for a shared account. It should include a list of individuals who have access to the shared account. The list will be reviewed at appropriate and documented intervals.

3.13.2. The system owner is responsible for the documentation, and a copy will be shared with WVOT.

3.13.3. The documentation must be available upon request for an audit or a security assessment.

3.14. Application and System Standards

3.14.1. Where technically or administratively feasible, Service Accounts shall be used.

3.14.2. WVOT offers Single Sign On and Multifactor Authentication methods. Applications authenticating to the Executive Domain must use a WVOT managed Authentication Method. External Authentication services for internally hosted Applications and Systems is prohibited.

3.14.3. Passwords must not be stored in clear text.

3.14.4. Role-based access controls should be used whenever feasible, in order to support changes in staff or assigned duties.

3.14.5. Where technically or administratively feasible, systems should allow for lock-outs after three (3) failed attempts. Lock-outs should be logged unless the log information includes password information.

4. POLICY SPECIFIC DEFINITIONS

4.1. Access - the ability to locate, gain entry to, and use a directory, file, or device on a computer system or over a network.

4.2. Access Controls – the enforcement of specified authorization rules based on positive identification of users and the systems or data they are permitted to access.

4.3. Authentication – the process of verifying the identity of a user.

4.4. Chief Information Officer (CIO) - the person designated by the governor to lead the WV Office of Technology and oversee information technology practices and initiatives for the Executive Brand of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.5. Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) - The primary section within WVOT that takes the lead on a specific policy or procedure. Usually the WVOT service provider/owner that the policy is related to or governs.

4.6. Procedure – a defined series or sequence of steps followed in a definite regular order ensuring the consistent and repetitive approach to actions.

4.7. User – a person authorized to access an information resource.

4.8. West Virginia Office of Technology (WVOT) - The division of the Department of Administration established by WV Code § 5A-6-4a, et. seq., which is led by the State's CIO and designated to acquire, operate, and maintain the State's technology infrastructure. The WVOT is responsible for evaluating equipment and services, and reviewing information technology contracts.

5. RELEVANT MATERIALS AND DOCUMENTS

5.1. 45 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) §§ 164.308-316

5.2. Freedom of Information Act

5.3. Gramm-Leach Bliley Act (GLBA)

5.4. Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Privacy Rule

5.5. NIST SP 800-14 and NIST SP 800-53

5.6. State Health Privacy Laws

5.7. WV Code § 5A-6-4a

5.8. WV Executive Order No. 7-03

5.9. WVOT Policies Issued by the Chief Information Officer (CIO), https://sites.google.com/wv.gov/othub/policy-governance/ot-policies